Horizon Europe

European Research Council (ERC)
Frontier Research Grants

Application Forms
Starting Grant Call (HE ERC StG)

European Research Council
Executive Agency

Established by the European Commission

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Version	Publication Date	Description
1.0	25.02.2021	▪ Application Forms to the ERC Starting Grant 2021 call
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5.0	10.07.2024	▪ Application Forms to the ERC Starting Grant 2025 call
6.0	08.07.2025	▪ Application Forms to the ERC Starting Grant 2026 call

Application form (Part A)

Example, not to be completed

Call:
()

Topic:

Type of Action:
()

Proposal number:

Proposal acronym:

Type of Model Grant Agreement:

Table of contents

Section	Title	Action
1	General information	
2	Participants	
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4	Ethics and security	
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Example, not to be completed

How to fill in the forms

The administrative forms must be filled in for each proposal using the templates available in the submission system. Some data fields in the administrative forms are pre-filled based on the steps in the submission wizard.

1 - General information

Field(s) marked * are mandatory to fill.

Topic	Type of Action
Call	Type of Model Grant Agreement

Acronym

Proposal title: *The title should be no longer than 200 characters (with spaces) and should be understandable to the non-specialist in your field.*

Note that for technical reasons, the following characters are not accepted in the Proposal Title and will be removed: < > " &

Duration in months*: *Estimated duration of the project in full months.*

Primary ERC Review Panel*:

Secondary ERC Review Panel: Not applicable (if applicable)

ERC Keyword 1*: As first keyword please choose one which is linked to the Primary Review Panel.

Please select, if applicable, the ERC keyword(s) that best characterise the subject of your proposal in order of priority.

ERC Keyword 2: *Not applicable*

ERC Keyword 3: *Not applicable*

ERC Keyword 4: *Not applicable*

Free keywords: *In addition, please enter free text keywords that you consider best characterise the scope of your proposal.The choice of keywords should take into account any multi-disciplinary aspects of the proposal.*

Example, not to be completed

Application forms

Proposal ID

Acronym

Abstract *

Remaining characters 2000

Has this proposal (or a very similar one) been submitted in the past 2 years in response to a call for proposals under any EU programme, including the current call? * ◯ Yes ◯ No

Please give the proposal reference or contract number.

Remove

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym

Declarations

Field(s) marked * are mandatory to fill.

1) We declare to have the explicit consent of all applicants on their participation and on the content of this proposal. * ☐

2) We confirm that the information contained in this proposal is correct and complete and that none of the project activities have started before the proposal was submitted (unless explicitly authorised in the call conditions). ☐

3) We declare:
- to be fully compliant with the eligibility criteria set out in the call
- not to be subject to any exclusion grounds under the EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046
- to have the financial and operational capacity to carry out the proposed project.

☐

4) We acknowledge that all communication will be made through the Funding & Tenders Portal electronic exchange system and that access and use of this system is subject to the Funding & Tenders Portal Terms and Conditions. ☐

5) We have read, understood and accepted the Funding & Tenders Portal Terms & Conditions and Privacy Statement that set out the conditions of use of the Portal and the scope, purposes, retention periods, etc. for the processing of personal data of all data subjects whose data we communicate for the purpose of the application, evaluation, award and subsequent management of our grant, prizes and contracts (including financial transactions and audits). ☐

6) We declare that the proposal complies with ethical principles (including the highest standards of research integrity as set out in the ALLEA European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity, as well as applicable international and national law, including the Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union and the European Convention on Human Rights and its Supplementary Protocols. Appropriate procedures, policies and structures are in place to foster responsible research practices, to prevent questionable research practices and research misconduct, and to handle allegations of breaches of the principles and standards in the Code of Conduct. ☐

7) We declare that the proposal has an exclusive focus on civil applications (activities intended to be used in military application or aiming to serve military purposes cannot be funded). If the project involves dual-use items in the sense of Regulation 428/2009, or other items for which authorisation is required, we confirm that we will comply with the applicable regulatory framework (e.g. obtain export/import licences before these items are used). ☐

8) We confirm that the activities proposed do not
- aim at human cloning for reproductive purposes;
- intend to modify the genetic heritage of human beings which could make such changes heritable (with the exception of research relating to cancer treatment of the gonads, which may be financed), or
- intend to create human embryos solely for the purpose of research or for the purpose of stem cell procurement, including by means of somatic cell nuclear transfer.
- lead to the destruction of human embryos (for example, for obtaining stem cells)

These activities are excluded from funding. ☐

9) We confirm that for activities carried out outside the Union, the same activities would have been allowed in at least one EU Member State. ☐

The coordinator is only responsible for the information relating to their own organisation. Each applicant remains responsible for the information declared for their organisation. If the proposal is retained for EU funding, they will all be required to sign a declaration of honour.

False statements or incorrect information may lead to administrative sanctions under the EU Financial Regulation.

Example, not to be completed

2 - Participants

List of participating organisations

#	Participating Organisation Legal Name	Country	Action
1			

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

Short name

Organisation data

Host Institution

PIC	Legal name

Short name:

Address

Street

Town

Postcode

Country

Webpage

Specific Legal Statuses

Legal person	unknown
Public body	unknown
Non-profit	unknown
International organisation	unknown
Secondary or Higher education establishment	unknown
Research organisation	unknown

SME Data

Based on the below details from the Participant Registry the organisation is not an SME (small- and medium-sized enterprise) for the call.

SME self-declared status	unknown
SME self-assessment	unknown
SME validation sme	unknown

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

Short name

Gender Equality Plan

Does the organization have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) covering the elements listed below? ○ Yes ◉ No

Minimum requirements (building blocks) for a GEP

Public GEP: formal document published on the institution's website and signed by the top management, addressing the following issues:

- **Dedicated resources:** commitment of human resources and gender expertise to implement it.
- **Data collection and monitoring:** sex/gender disaggregated data on personnel and students and annual reporting based on indicators.
- **Training:** Awareness raising/trainings on gender equality and unconscious gender biases for staff and decision-makers.
- **Minimum areas** to be **covered** and addressed via concrete measures and targets:
    - work-life balance and organisational culture;
    - gender balance in leadership and decision-making;
    - gender equality in recruitment and career progression;
    - integration of the gender dimension into research and teaching content;
    - measures against gender-based violence including sexual harassment.

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

Short name

Departments carrying out the proposed work

Department 1

Department name *Name of the department/institute carrying out the work.* ☐ not applicable

☐ Same as proposing organisation's address

Street *Please enter street name and number.*

Town *Please enter the name of the town.*

Postcode *Area code.*

Country *Please select a country*

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

Short name

Principal Investigator

The following information of the Principal Investigator (PI) is used to personalise the communications. The EU services will contact the PI together with the HI contact person concerning this proposal (e.g. for additional information, invitation to interviews, sending of evaluation results, convocation to start grant preparation). Please make sure that your personal information is accurate and please inform the ERC in case your e-mail address changes by using the call specific e-mail address indicated in the below webpage. Please also provide your mobile phone number as we may need to urgently contact you regarding your submitted proposal and/or potential interview.

https://erc.europa.eu/about-erc/contact-us

The name and e-mail of contact persons including the Principal Investigator, Host Institution contact are read-only in the administrative form, only additional details can be edited here. To give access rights and contact details of contact persons, please save and close this form, then go back to Participants Step of the submission wizard and save the changes.

ORCID: If you have a ORCID number please enter it here (e.g. 9999-9999-9999-999X. where 9 represents numbers and X represents numbers up to 10)

Researcher ID

The maximum length of the identifier is 11 characters (ZZZ-9999-2010) and the minimum length is 9 characters (A-1001-2010).

Other ID: Please enter the type of ID here | Please enter the identifier number here

Career Stage

Last Name*		Last Name at Birth	
First Name(s)*		Gender*	◯ Male ◯ Female ◯ Non Binary
Title		Country of residence	
Nationality*		Country of Birth*	
Date of Birth* (DD/MM/YYYY)		Place of Birth*	

Contact address

Current organisation name

Current Department/Faculty/Institute/ Laboratory name

☐ Same as organisation address

Street	Please enter street name and number.		
Postcode/Cedex		Country*	
Town*			
Phone	+xxx xxxxxxxxx	Phone2 / Mobile	+xxx xxxxxxxxx
E-mail*			

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

Short name

This will be the person the EU services will contact concerning this proposal (e.g. for additional information, invitation to hearings, sending of evaluation results, convocation to start grant preparation). The data in blue is read-only. Details (name, first name and e-mail) of Main Contact persons should be edited in the step "Participants" of the submission wizard.

Title _____ Gender ◯ Woman ◯ Man ◯ Non Binary

First name* Last name*

E-Mail*

Position in org. Please indicate the position of the person.

Department *Name of the department/institute carrying out the work.* ☐ Same as organisation name

☐ Same as proposing organisation's address

Street *Please enter street name and number.*

Town *Please enter the name of the town.* Post code *Area code.*

Country *Please select a country*

Website *Please enter website*

Phone *+xxx xxxxxxxxx* *Phone 2* *+xxx xxxxxxxxx*

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

3 - Budget

?

Beneficiary Short Name	PI	Senior Staff	Postdocs	Students	Other Personnel costs	A. Total personnel costs/€	B. Subcontracting Costs/€ (No indirect costs)	C.1 Travel and subsistence	C.2 Equipment - including major equipment	Consum-ables incl. fieldwork and animal costs	Publications (incl. Open Access fees) and dissemination	Other additional direct costs	C.3 Total other goods, works and services	Total Purchase costs/€	D. Internally invoiced goods and services/€ (No indirect costs)	E. Indirect Cost/€	Total Eligible Costs	Requested EU contribution /€
	0	0	0	0	0	0.00	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.00	0.00	0	0.00	0.00	0.00
Total	0	0	0	0	0	0.00	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.00	0.00	0	0.00	0.00	0.00

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

Section C. Resources (Maximum 8000 characters allowed)

?

This section and the budget table will be made available to the experts evaluating the proposal at Step 2. Important: your description of resources will be truncated once it exceeds the maximum allowed characters. Please make sure that your description is complete before submitting.

State and fully justify the amount of funding considered necessary to fulfil the objectives for the duration of the project. The project cost estimation should be as accurate as possible. The evaluation panels assess the estimated costs carefully; unjustified budgets will be consequently reduced. Please specify if you will use third parties giving in-kind contributions to the action.

If applicable, please specify the cost items covered by your 'Other personnel costs' category and the cost items covered by your 'Other additional direct costs' category.

Request for additional funding if applicable (All items MUST be included in the overall budget table above): (Cost in EUR)

Justification:

Remaining characters 7011

Example, not to be completed

4 - Ethics & security

Ethics Issues Table

1. Human Embryonic Stem Cells and Human Embryos			Page
Does this activity involve Human Embryonic Stem Cells (hESCs)?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Will they be directly derived from embryos within this project?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they previously established cells lines?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are the cell lines registered in the European registry for human embryonic stem cell lines	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does this activity involve the use of human embryos?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Will the activity lead to their destruction?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

2. Humans			Page
Does this activity involve human participants?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they volunteers for non medical studies (e.g. social or human sciences research)?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they healthy volunteers for medical studies?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they patients for medical studies?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they potentially vulnerable individuals or groups?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they children/minors?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they other persons unable to give informed consent?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does this activity involve interventions (physical also including imaging technology, behavioural treatments, etc.) on the study participants?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does it involve invasive techniques?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does it involve collection of biological samples?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does this activity involve conducting a clinical study as defined by the Clinical Trial Regulation (EU 536/2014)? (using pharmaceuticals, biologicals, radiopharmaceuticals, or advanced therapy medicinal products)	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Is it a clinical trial?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Is it a low-intervention clinical trial?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

3. Human Cells / Tissues (not covered by section 1)			Page
Does this activity involve the use of human cells or tissues?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they human embryonic or foetal cells or tissues?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they available commercially?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

Example, not to be completed

Are they obtained within this project?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they obtained from another project, laboratory or institution?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they obtained from biobank?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

4. Personal Data			Page
Does this activity involve processing of personal data?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does it involve the processing of special categories of personal data (e.g.: genetic, biometric and health data, sexual lifestyle, ethnicity, political opinion, religious or philosophical beliefs)?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does it involve processing of genetic, biometric or health data?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does it involve profiling, systematic monitoring of individuals, or processing of large scale of special categories of data or intrusive methods of data processing (such as, surveillance, geolocation tracking etc.)?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does this activity involve further processing of previously collected personal data (including use of preexisting data sets or sources, merging existing data sets)?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Is it planned to export personal data from the EU to non-EU countries? Specify the type of personal data and countries involved	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Is it planned to import personal data from non-EU countries into the EU or from a non-EU country to another non-EU country? Specify the type of personal data and countries involved	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does this activity involve the processing of personal data related to criminal convictions or offences?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

5. Animals			Page
Does this activity involve animals?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they vertebrates?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they non-human primates? (NHP)	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they genetically modified?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they cloned farm animals?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are they endangered species?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

6. Non-EU Countries			Page
Will some of the activities be carried out in non-EU countries?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
In case non-UE countries are involved, do the activities undertaken in these countries raise potential ethics issues?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
It is planned to use local resources (e.g. animal and/or human tissue samples, genetic material, live animals, human remains, materials of historical value, endangered fauna or flora samples, etc.)?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Is it planned to import any material (other than data) from non-EU countries into the EU or from a non-EU country to another non-EU country? For data imports, see section 4.	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Is it planned to export any material (other than data) from the EU to non-EU countries? For data exports, see section 4.	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does this activity involve low and/or lower middle income countries, (if yes, detail the benefit-sharing actions planned in the self-assessment)	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Could the situation in the country put the individuals taking part in the activity at risk?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

7. Environment, Health and Safety	Page

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym

Does this activity involve the use of substances or processes that may cause harm to the environment, to animals or plants.(during the implementation of the activity or further to the use of the results, as a possible impact) ?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does this activity deal with endangered fauna and/or flora / protected areas?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does this activity involve the use of substances or processes that may cause harm to humans, including those performing the activity.(during the implementation of the activity or further to the use of the results, as a possible impact) ?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

8. Artificial Intelligence			Page
Does this activity involve the development, deployment and/or use of Artificial Intelligence? (if yes, detail in the self-assessment whether that could raise ethical concerns related to human rights and values and detail how this will be addressed).	◯ Yes	◉ No	

9. Other Ethics Issues			Page
Are there any other ethics issues that should be taken into consideration?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

I confirm that I have taken into account all ethics issues above and that, if any ethics issues apply, I will complete the ethics self-assessment as described in the guidelines How to Complete your Ethics Self-Assessment ☐

Example, not to be completed

Ethics Self-Assessment

Ethical dimension of the objectives, methodology and likely impact
Explain in detail the identified issues in relation to: - objectives of the activities (e.g. study of vulnerable populations, etc.) - methodology (e.g. clinical trials, involvement of children, protection of personal data, etc.) - the potential impact of the activities (e.g. environmental damage, stigmatisation of particular social groups, political or financial adverse consequences, misuse, etc.)
Compliance with ethical principles and relevant legislations
Describe how the issue(s) identified in the ethics issues table above will be addressed in order to adhere to the ethical principles and what will be done to ensure that the activities are compliant with the EU/national legal and ethical requirements of the country or countries where the tasks are to be carried out. It is reminded that for activities performed in a non-EU countries, they should also be allowed in at least one EU Member State.

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym

Security issues table

1. EU Classified Information (EUCI)[2]			Page
Does this activity involve information and/or materials requiring protection against unauthorised disclosure (EUCI)?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Is the activity going to use classified information as background[3] information?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Is the activity going to generate EU classified foreground[4] information as result?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does this activity involve non-EU countries?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Do participants from non-EU countries need to have access to EUCI?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Do the non-EU countries concerned have a security of information agreement with the EU?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

2. Misuse			Page
Does this activity have the potential for misuse of results?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Does the activity provide knowledge, materials and technologies that could be channeled into crime and/or terrorism?	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Could the activity result in the development of chemical, biological, radiological or nuclear (CBRN) weapons and the means for their delivery?	◯ Yes	◉ No	

3. Other Security Issues			Page
Does this activity involve information and/or materials subject to national security restrictions? If yes, please specify: (Maximum number of characters allowed: 1000)	◯ Yes	◉ No	
Are there any other security issues that should be taken into consideration? If yes, please specify: (Maximum number of characters allowed: 1000)	◯ Yes	◉ No	

[2]According to the Commission Decision (EU, Euratom) 2015/444 of 13 March 2015 on the security rules for protecting EU classified information, "European Union classified information (EUCI) means any information or material designated by an EU security classification, the unauthorised disclosure of which could cause varying degrees of prejudice to the interests of the European Union or of one or more of the Member States".

[3]Classified background information is information that is already classified by a country and/or international organisation and/or the EU and is going to be used by the project. In this case, the project must have in advance the authorisation from the originator of the classified information, which is the entity (EU institution, EU Member State, third state or international organisation) under whose authority the classified information has been generated.

[4]EU classified foreground information is information (documents/deliverables/materials) planned to be generated by the project and that needs to be protected from unauthorised disclosure. The originator of the EUCI generated by the project is the European Commission.

Example, not to be completed

5 - Other questions

Academic data	
PhD reference date	
Date of earliest award (PhD or equivalent) - DD/MM/YYYY *	
Applicants holding a Medical degree	
Are you a medical doctor or do you hold a degree in medicine? Please note that if you have also been awarded a PhD, your medical degree may be your first eligible degree. (please see the ERC Information for Applicants to the Starting and Consolidator Grant for more details).	◯ Yes ◯ No
Extension Requests	
With respect to the earliest award (PhD or equivalent), I request an extension of the eligibility window, (indicate number of days) [see the applicable ERC Work Programme and the Information for Applicants to the Starting and Consolidator Grant Call].	◯ Yes ◯ No
Working time commitment	
Please indicate your percentage of working time in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe Associated Country over the period of the grant. Please note that you are expected to spend a minimum of 50% of your total working time in an EU Member State or Associated Country.*	
Please indicate the % of working time you (as PI) will dedicate to the project over the period of the grant. Please note that PIs are expected to dedicate a minimum of working time to the project (30% for AdG, 40% for CoG and 50% for StG). The personnel cost for the PI provided in section "3-Budget" cannot be higher than the percentage indicated here. This information will be provided to the experts at Step 2 together with the section "3-Budget".*	
ERC eligibility requirements	
Please acknowledge that you are aware of the eligibility requirements for applying for this ERC call as specified in the ERC Annual Work Programme, and please certify that, to the best of your knowledge your application is in compliance with all these requirements. Please note that your proposal may be declared ineligible at any point during the evaluation or granting process if it is found not to be compliant with these eligibility criteria.*	☐
Consent obtained from participants and researchers	
Please confirm that you (as PI) have the written consent of all participants on their involvement and the content of this proposal, as well as of any researcher mentioned in the proposal on their participation in the project (either as team member, collaborator, other PI or member of the advisory board). We may request you to provide proof of the written consent obtained at any time during the evaluation.*	☐
Sharing evaluation data	
If your proposal is not funded (due to budget limitations), do you consent to allow us to disclose the results of your evaluation (score and ranking range), together with your name (as PI), non-confidential proposal title, acronym, abstract and your/your host institution's contact details to national or regional public research funding authorities that run funding schemes specifically for ERC applicants that scored highly in the evaluation?	◯ Yes ◯ No

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym

If your proposal is funded, do you consent to allow us to disclose your name (as PI), non-confidential proposal title, acronym, abstract and your/your host institution's contact details to institutions that are awarding prizes to excellent researchers?	◯ Yes ◯ No

Example, not to be completed

Proposal ID

Acronym

Excluded Reviewers

You can provide up to three names of persons that should not act as an evaluator in the evaluation of the proposal for potential competitive reasons.

First Name	
Last Name	
Institution	
Town	
Country	
Webpage	

Example, not to be completed

Validation result

Show Error

The red 'Show Error' button indicates an error due to a missing or incorrect value related to the call eligibility criteria. The submission of the proposal **will be blocked** unless that specific field is corrected!

Show Warning

The yellow 'Show Warning' button indicates a warning due to a missing or incorrect value related to the call eligibility criteria. The submission of the proposal **will not be blocked (**proposal will be submitted with the missing or incorrect value).

Section	Description
	The form has not yet been validated, click "Validate Form" to do so!

Example, not to be completed

Project proposal – Technical description (Part B)

Example, not to be completed

ERC Starting Grant 2026
Part B1[1]
(Part B1 is evaluated in Step 1 and Step 2, Part B2 is evaluated in Step 2 only)

Proposal Full Title

PROPOSAL ACRONYM

Cover Page:
- Name of the Principal Investigator (PI)
- Name of the PI's Host Institution for the project
- Proposal duration in months

Text highlighted in grey should be deleted.

Proposal summary (identical to the abstract from the online proposal submission forms, section 1).

The abstract (summary) should, at a glance, provide the reader with a clear understanding of the objectives of the research proposal and how they will be achieved. The abstract will be used as the short description of your research proposal in the evaluation process and in communications to contact in particular potential independent external experts and/or to inform the Commission and/or the programme management committees and/or relevant national funding agencies. It must therefore be short and precise, and should not contain confidential information.

Please use plain typed text, avoiding formulae and other special characters. The abstract must be written in English. There is a limit of 2000 characters (spaces and line breaks included).

If a secondary panel is indicated in the online proposal submission forms, please explain and justify the cross-panel or cross-domain nature of your proposal here. There is a limit of 1000 characters (spaces and line breaks included).

Example, not to be completed

[1] Instructions for completing Part B1 can be found in the '*Information for Applicants to the Starting and Consolidator Grant 2026 Calls*'.

Part I of the Scientific Proposal (max. 5 pages, references do not count towards the page limit).

Please note the changes as from 2026 calls regarding Part I and Part II of the Scientific Proposal and read carefully the "ERC Work Programme 2026" and the "Information for Applicants to the Starting and Consolidator Grant 2026 Calls".

[***Part I of the Scientific Proposal*** *should present the envisaged research and it should:*

- *lay out the current state of knowledge,*
- *explain the scientific question and the objectives of the project, and*
- *present the overall approach or research strategy to reach the goals of the project.*

Part I should convince the evaluation Panel that it presents an original and creative idea addressing an important question in the respective research field(s). Furthermore, it should substantiate how the project will advance the frontier of knowledge, and what contribution it will make to the research field(s) i.e. what may be changed, opened, challenged or how the results of the work will alter the current understanding of the field.

At Step 1, only Part I and the Curriculum Vitae (CV) and Track Record (see below) is assessed by the evaluation Panel. *It forms the basis for the Panel's decision whether it chooses to evaluate the proposal in the next step. Therefore, all essential information must be covered in this section.*

References to literature should also be included. Please use a reference style that is commonly used in your discipline such as American Chemical Society (ACS) style, American Medical Association (AMA) style, Modern Language Association (MLA) style, etc. and that allows the evaluators to easily retrieve each reference.

Please respect the following formatting constraints: Times New Roman, Arial or similar, at least font size 11, margin sizes (2.0 cm side and 1.5 cm top and bottom), single line spacing.]

Example, not to be completed

Curriculum vitae and Track Record (max. 4 pages)

[You may modify the below template if necessary.]

PERSONAL DETAILS

[Provide your personal details, your education and key qualifications, current position(s) and relevant previous positions you have held.]

Family name, First name:

Researcher unique identifier(s) (such as ORCID, Research ID, etc. ...):

URL for website:

- **Education and key qualifications**

DD/MM/YYYY PhD
Name of Faculty/ Department, Name of University/ Institution, Country
Name of PhD Supervisor
YYYY Master
Name of Faculty/ Department, Name of University/ Institution, Country

- **Current position(s)**

YYYY - YYYY Current Position
Name of Faculty/ Department, Name of University/ Institution/ Country
YYYY – YYYY Current Position
Name of Faculty/ Department, Name of University/ Institution/ Country

- **Previous position(s)**

YYYY - YYYY Position held
Name of Faculty/ Department, Name of University/ Institution/ Country
YYYY - YYYY Position held
Name of Faculty/ Department, Name of University/ Institution/ Country

RESEARCH ACHIEVEMENTS AND PEER RECOGNITION

Research achievements

[Provide a list of up to ten research outputs that demonstrate how you have advanced knowledge in your field with an emphasis on more recent achievements, such as publications, articles deposited in a publicly available preprint server, books, book chapters, conference proceedings, data sets, software, patents, licenses, standards, start-up businesses or any other research outputs you deem relevant in relation to your research field and your project.

You may include a short, factual explanation of the significance of the selected outputs, your role in producing each of them, and how they demonstrate your capacity to successfully carry out your proposed project.]

Peer recognition

[Provide a list of selected examples of significant recognition by your peers if applicable, such as prizes, awards, fellowships, elected academy memberships, invited presentations to major conferences or any other examples of significant recognition you deem relevant in relation to your research field and project.

You may include a short explanation of the significance of the listed examples.]

Example, not to be completed

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

[*You may provide relevant additional information on your research career to provide context to the evaluation panels when assessing your research achievements and peer recognition as described above].*

Career breaks, diverse career paths and major life events

[*You may include a short factual explanation of career breaks or diverse career paths such as secondments, volunteering, part-time work, time spent in different sectors or the effects of major life events such as long-term illness, including events that have no impact on eligibility, such as the effects of pandemic restrictions on research productivity*.]

Other contributions to the research community

[*You may include a list of particularly noteworthy contributions to the research community you have made other than research achievements and peer recognition, and a short explanation of these contributions. The purpose of this section is to allow the evaluation Panel to take a more rounded view of your career and achievements and to ensure that any additional responsibilities, commitments and leadership roles that you have taken on beyond your individual research activities are recognised and taken into account.]*

[(for more information see 'Information for Applicants to the Starting and Consolidator Grant 2026 Calls')]

Do NOT split Part I from the CV and Track Record and/or references and do NOT upload them as separate documents. The peer reviewers will only receive one single document for evaluation at Step 1. Hence, Part B1 should contain all elements as explained in this template. If some parts of Part B1 are uploaded in the submission system as separate attachments, the peer reviewers will not have access to them.

Example, not to be completed

ERC Starting Grant 2026
Part B2[1]
(not evaluated in Step 1)

Part II of the Scientific Proposal (max. 7 pages, references do not count towards the page limits).

Text highlighted in grey should be deleted.

Please note the changes as from 2026 calls regarding Part I and Part II of the Scientific Proposal and read carefully the "ERC Work Programme 2026" and the "Information for Applicants to the Starting and Consolidator Grant 2026 Calls".

[Part II of the Scientific Proposal should be a detailed explanation of the project implementation, including research methodology, work plan, risk assessment, mitigating measures and any further necessary background not included in Part I.]

Please respect the following formatting constraints: Times New Roman, Arial or similar, at least font size 11, margins (2.0 cm side and 1.5 cm top and bottom), single line spacing.

Do NOT split Part II from the references and/or the appendix (Funding ID) and do NOT upload them as separate documents.

Do NOT include any description of resources or budget table here (Part B2). The Resources section and the detailed budget table are part of the online submission form (Part A, Section 3 - Budget) which will be extracted and provided to the peer reviewers. If additional documents are uploaded in the submission system as separate attachments, the peer reviewers will not have access to them.

Example, not to be completed

[1] Instructions for completing Part B2 can be found in the '*Information for Applicants to the Starting and Consolidator Grant 2026 Calls*'.

Appendix: All current grants and on-going / submitted grant applications of the PI (Funding ID)

Mandatory information (does not count towards page limits)

Current research grants (Please indicate "No funding" when applicable):

Project Title	*Funding source*	*Amount (Euros)*	*Period*	*Role of the PI*	*Relation to current ERC proposal*[2]

On-going / submitted grant applications (Please indicate "None" when applicable):

Project Title	*Funding source*	*Amount (Euros)*	*Period*	*Role of the PI*	*Relation to current ERC proposal*[2]

Example, not to be completed

[2] Describe clearly any scientific overlap between your ERC application and the current research grant or on-going grant application.

Commitment of the Host Institution for ERC Calls 2026[1, 2, 3]

The <<please fill in here the name of the legal entity that is associated to the proposal and may host the principal investigator and the project (action) in case the application is successful>>, which is the applicant legal entity,

confirms its intention to sign a supplementary agreement with
<<please fill in here the name of the principal investigator>>

in which the obligations listed below will be addressed should the proposal be retained.

Performance obligations of the *applicant legal entity* (Host Institution) that will become the coordinator of the HE ERC Grant Agreement (hereafter referred to as the Agreement), should the proposal be retained and the preparation of the Agreement be successfully concluded:

The applicant legal entity (Host Institution) commits itself to ensure that the action tasks described in Annex 1 of the Agreement are performed under the guidance of the principal investigator who is expected to devote:

- in the case of a Starting Grant at least 50% of her/his working time to the ERC-funded project (action) and spend at least 50% of her/his working time in an EU Member State or Associated Country;
- in the case of a Consolidator Grant at least 40% of her/his working time to the ERC-funded project (action) and spend at least 50% of her/his working time in an EU Member State or Associated Country;
- in the case of an Advanced Grant at least 30% of her/his working time to the ERC-funded project (action) and spend at least 50% of her/his working time in an EU Member State or Associated Country.

The applicant legal entity (Host Institution) commits itself to respect the following conditions for the principal investigator and their team:

a) host and engage the principal investigator for the whole duration of the action;

b) take all measures to implement the principles set out in the Commission recommendation on the European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers[4] — in particular regarding working conditions,

Example, not to be completed

[1] A scanned copy of the signed statement should be uploaded electronically via the Funding & Tenders Portal Submission Service in PDF format.

[2] The statement of commitment of the Host Institution refers to most obligations of the Host Institution, which are stated in the Model Grant Agreement used for ERC actions (MGA). The MGA is available on the Funding & Tenders Portal. The reference to the time commitment of the Principal Investigator is stated in the ERC Work Programme 2026.

[3] This statement (on letterhead paper) shall be signed with a legally binding signature (e.g. blue ink or digital signature) by the institution's legal representative indicating their name, function, email address and, in case of blue ink signature, along with the stamp of the institution.

[4] Commission Recommendation 2005/251/EC of 11 March 2005 on the European Charter for Researchers and on a Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (OJ L 75, 22.3.2005, p. 67).

transparent recruitment processes based on merit and career development — and ensure that the principal investigator, researchers and third parties involved in the action are aware of them;

c) enter — before grant signature— into a Supplementary Agreement with the principal investigator, that specifies the obligation of the applicant legal entity to meet its obligations under the Agreement;

d) provide the principal investigator with a copy of the signed Agreement;

e) guarantee the principal investigator scientific independence, in particular for the:
   i) use of the budget to achieve the scientific objectives;
   ii) authority to publish as senior author and invite as co-authors those who have contributed substantially to the work;
   iii) preparation of scientific reports for the action;
   iv) selection and supervision of the other team members, in line with the profiles needed to conduct the research and in accordance with the beneficiary's usual management practices;
   v) possibility to apply independently for funding;
   vi) access to appropriate space and facilities for conducting the research;

f) provide — during the implementation of the action — research support to the principal investigator and the team members (regarding infrastructure, equipment, access rights, products and other services necessary for conducting the research);

g) support the principal investigator and provide administrative assistance, in particular for the:
   i) general management of the work and their team;
   ii) scientific reporting, especially ensuring that the team members send their scientific results to the principal investigator;
   iii) financial reporting, especially providing timely and clear financial information;
   iv) application of the beneficiary's usual management practices;
   v) general logistics of the action;
   vi) access to the electronic exchange system;

h) inform the principal investigator immediately (in writing) of any events or circumstances likely to affect the Agreement;

i) ensure that the principal investigator enjoys adequate:
   i) conditions for annual, sickness and parental leave;
   ii) occupational health and safety standards;
   iii) insurance under the general social security scheme, such as pension rights;

j) allow the transfer of the Agreement to a new beneficiary, if requested by the principal investigator and provided that the objectives of the action remain achievable (portability; see Article 41 of the Agreement);

k) respect the fundamental principle of research integrity and ensure that persons carrying out research tasks under the action follow the good research practices and refrain from the research integrity violations described in the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity[5]. If any such violations or allegations occur, verify and pursue them and bring them to the attention of the Agency.

Example, not to be completed

[5] The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity – Revised Edition 2023. All European Academies, Berlin. DOI 10.26356/ECOC

For the applicant legal entity (Host Institution):

Date

……

Name and Function

…… ; ……

Email and legally binding signature of legal representative

…… ; ……

Stamp of the applicant legal entity (Host Institution)[6]

IMPORTANT NOTE:

In order to be complete, all the above mentioned items are mandatory and shall be included in the commitment of the Host Institution.

If the letter is digitally signed, please do NOT lock it.

Example, not to be completed

[6] No need to stamp this letter of support when it is digitally signed.